



Biometrics on the rise!

Was it not enough for the passports to have our fingerprints, France demands to have it at airports. <http://dgit.in/BioFrance>



Soviet Spying demystified.

Keyloggers are not a new thing. See how Soviets used it to spy in the cold war. <http://dgit.in/SovietSpy>



Wireless all the way

Our chats with NETGEAR's CEO unravel new perspectives about the wireless industry and how the IoT will improve our lives by huge margins.



◀ Patrick Lo, CEO, NETGEAR

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Q From a global perspective, what are some of the business opportunities for networking brands in the next years to come? And what are some of the challenges and roadblocks that need to be overcome to fully realize these opportunities?

Patrick: The IoT smarthome creates the biggest of the opportunity for any home networking companies because right now, not only that you are talking about connecting in not tens, but hundreds of devices in the house to the internet, so you need the bandwidth, you need the speed and the throughput and you need the ease of use, ease of connection. So that's one. The second one is that the speed alone is not going to be enough because in order to make a smart home real, you have to provide the ease of use and management, so software is super important. Software not only pertaining to the devices itself but software related to the router, the camera, the light bulbs and all that. Even the cloud back-end as well as the apps, everyone realizes that it's all about the software. So I would say that going forward, the challenge is way beyond just feel and speed but is also software.

Q Technology is changing the way we get work done, both at the personal as

well as company level. And how are networking brands enabling or adapting to the change?

Patrick: I think the most drastic change of getting the work done is that, one, it's a lot more efficient. For eg. I remember there is a new battery technology just invented by Stanford but I don't know when it is going to become commercialised. Earlier, you needed to go to the library and/or make ten phone calls to learn about something and now all now you need to do is to pick up your mobile phone, Google it and boom, you have the answers. So that's what is called productivity.

The second one which is also drastically different is that it's just like what we do at NETGEAR. We have about 300 R&D engineers of whom a lot work from different places. A lot of them work from home. This was totally impossible previously without this mobile technology, so today people could work at the beach or from home and they could still be staying in contact with our colleagues. A month ago in Australia, we demonstrated our mobile router with the latest employment of 4G LTE technology. It can actually achieve a download speed of 550 Mega-bits per second which is quite a lot.

Now what is the matter? The matter is that the people are happier. We have tested so many times in the US and

concluded that a happier workforce is a flexible workforce. Flexible in terms of work hours and work places. So when you want to work, you need the high-speed internet and you need powerful mobile devices, but without the internet speed, life is just going to be tough. You had to choose between working or taking care of the kids and going to soccer matches. Now you don't have to make that choice.

Q The networking industry is not just about connecting devices to each other or the internet anymore. It's so much more. Almost everyone is in a reinventing mode. Is it a natural evolution or an industry struggling to not be commoditised and keep itself relevant.

Patrick: All that is true as you said. As you have seen it, any hardware, without software is going to get commoditised in no time. So that's why you see, if you are just making a pair of jeans, just blue denim, no design, you racing to the bottom. It's the same thing for technology products. The major differentiation of technology products is software. Innovation is about how to add value and we all know in this business world, the added value of a product, is equivalent to the profit margin of the product. If you do not add any value, there is absolutely no reason why you should make a profit. **Q**